
The clips PDQ got wrong

Where I got to, what stopped me, what I found



Find why PDQ names the wrong film, and fix it

- Users press "wrong" when PDQ names the wrong film
- I have to find the pattern and change a rule
- But stricter rules also break films it currently gets right

So every change gets counted twice

Wrong answers removed · Right answers broken

The engine on my laptop is the pod's engine

PASS

Rules check
31,715 searches, 0 differences

PASS

Fingerprint check
byte for byte identical

80

films in my index

9.7m

fingerprints

39 + 39

wrong clips · control clips

So when my results change later, it is the rule I changed. Not my laptop.

39 clips in. 2 I could actually use.

39

on the wrong list

20

downloaded

3

matched any

2

reproduc

19 would not download at all. 17 of the rest no longer match anything.

Two separate problems

19

would not download

15 TikTok · tool cannot get past it

4 Instagram · want a login

17

match nothing now

Not a weak match. Nothing.

Checked with and without pre-scan

I think the videos at those links are not the videos that were traced.

Social posts get edited, deleted and re-uploaded. The database keeps no copy and no scorecard.

Same clip. Same index. Opposite answer.

WITH THE PRE-SCAN

VERDICT: The In Between

4 frames, best distance 18
found the film at the 5s mark

WITHOUT THE PRE-SCAN

VERDICT: no film accepted

best distance 66
gave up after 1.6s

- The pre-scan skims the whole clip and finds the matching moment
- The probe takes a few frames off the front and lands nowhere near it
- The film was in the index the whole time

It fired on the weakest rule there is

[EARLY EXIT] P8: 31 frames in 35-45 (≥ 30)

31

frames found

30

frames needed

41.4

average distance

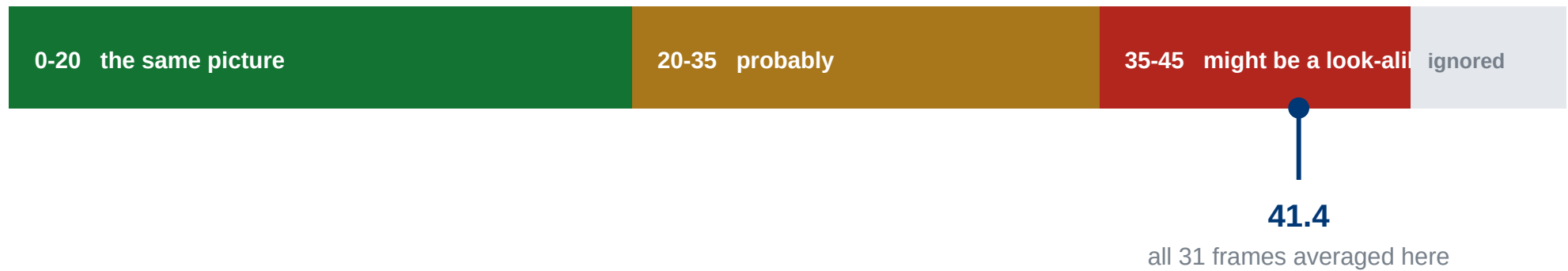
0

frames in the strong or medium band

Over the line by one frame, on matches that were nearly bad enough to throw away.

P8 counts frames and nothing else. It never checks where in the film they landed, or where in the clip they came from.

Where 41.4 sits



Lower is better. Zero means the two pictures are identical.

The whole answer was built out of the worst evidence the system still accepts.

Both scraped over the line

Demeter	needed 30 frames	had 31
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The In Between	needed 3 frames	had 4
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One frame fewer and neither would have answered at all.

Two clips proves nothing. But it matches what the notes say a wrong answer looks like, so it tells me where to start once I have more.

The notes and the engine do not agree

*"Since 6 Aug 2026 the top of the weak band, 40 to 45, is hint only.
They can never make PDQ answer on their own."*

- My clip was answered by P8 on frames averaging 41.4
- Reading the engine, P8 counts every frame from 36 up to the cut-off
- It does nothing special with the 40 to 45 part

Is that handled somewhere else, or does P8 skip it?

If it applies to P8, this wrong answer probably would not have happened.

Three things would unblock me

1 Does the pod keep the clips it traces?

There is a clip_hash column, so they were hashed. The files may be stored somewhere.

2 How does the pod download from TikTok?

Mine cannot. That is 15 of my 39.

3 Are the [EARLY EXIT] log lines kept?

The rule that fired only exists in the log. I could read all 39 without replaying.

I am ready to start on the engine. Clips are what I do not have.

Once I have the clips

- 1 Replay every clip twice, with and without the pre-scan
- 2 Write down the rule and the scorecard for each one
- 3 Find what the wrong ones have in common
- 4 Change one number in the engine
- 5 Replay both lists and report the two counts

Wrong answers removed · **Right answers broken**
Both numbers, every time.